Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Thursday, 5 November 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Light drizzle	Overcast	Overcast	Overcast
11° 9°	10° 7°	11° 9°	11° 5°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Time to focus on cost of living, says PM after US election results.**
Andy Burnham says prices won't come down until the US's conflict with Iran is resolved.
UK · NEWS

2 **Miliband says slavery apology will not bring cost for UK taxpayers.**
Speaking to BBC's Newscast, the foreign secretary says Britain cannot sweep its past "under the carpet".
UK · NEWS

3 **Fourth arrest after Halloween party stabbings.**
All five boys who were injured had been invited to attend the supervised party on Saturday night.
UK · NEWS

4 **Kellogg's admits snap, crackle and pop is quieter after uproar over Rice Krispies recipe change.**
The cereal giant has changed the recipes for Rice Krispies and Coco Pops, sparking a backlash online.
UK · NEWS

5 **Fewer mothers to appear in court days after giving birth under new guidance.**
The changes follow concerns over the number of mothers summoned to safeguarding hearings shortly after labour.
POLITICS · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Celebrity hairstylist John Frieda dies aged 75.**
He was stylist to the stars in the 1960s and 1970s before creating a global range of hair products.
SHOWBIZ · UK

2 **Tributes paid to drummer with dozens of number ones.**
Amarillo singer Tony Christie says Clem Cattini was a "world class" musician and gentleman.
SHOWBIZ · UK

3 **Celebrity loses injunction bid but will stay anonymous pending appeal.**
The unnamed man asked for an injunction to stop his identity being reported in connection with allegations against him.
SHOWBIZ · UK

4 **Jury in Russell Brand rape trial begins considering verdicts.**
The media personality has been on trial for three weeks, after pleading not guilty to all charges.
SHOWBIZ · UK

5 **Comedian Karen Dunbar cancels tour dates claiming promoter has not paid her.**
Dunbar claimed she had only been paid for five of her previous 39 tour dates, a claim disputed by promoter Breakneck Comedy.
SHOWBIZ · UK

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **An island in mourning: Tenerife processes death of De Miguel.**
Tenerife football club and the wider football community mourn the loss of footballer Jesus de Miguel following an on-field collision.
SPORT · UK

2 **Why Man Utd's Roma comeback has echoes of Mourinho and Solskjaer.**
After their memorable comeback victory against Roma, can Manchester United avoid a repeat of the past and follow that up with a successive victory?
SPORT · UK

3 **Zverev annoyed by reaction to becoming world number one.**
After a defeat at the Paris Masters, Alexander Zverev complains that he is the only player who has had "to explain why it's OK" for him to be top of the rankings.
SPORT · UK

4 **'Most difficult days of my life' for Owono after De Miguel death.**
FC Andorra goalkeeper Jesus Owono puts out a statement through his club, expressing his sorrow and pain after Tenerife forward Jesus de Miguel's death.
SPORT · UK

5 **How landmark Everton compensation prevented Burnley record loss.**
Burnley have published promising financial results, but under the hood is a payment from Everton which makes the picture look far less positive.
SPORT · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **A fascinating study suggests that the soothing flicker of a real candle is becoming a popular way to unwind.**
Many people are rediscovering the simple, analogue joy of candlelight as an antidote to screen fatigue. It seems a gentle glow is more calming than a bright blue light!

2 **Researchers are noting a surprising trend: the quiet satisfaction of 'perfectly aligning the spines of books on a shelf'.**
There's a curious sense of accomplishment many feel when their bookshelves look just so. It's a small victory in a busy world.

3 **The unexpected joy of 'unravelling a tangled ball of string' is gaining recognition as a therapeutic pastime.**
It appears the methodical nature of untangling can be surprisingly meditative, offering a little challenge with a satisfying resolution.

4 **A new appreciation for the 'distinctive crunch of autumn leaves underfoot' is bringing cheer to daily walks.**
It's a simple, seasonal pleasure that connects us to nature. That satisfying sound can truly lift the spirits on a brisk morning.

5 **More people are finding unexpected delight in 'the satisfying click of a well-placed postage stamp'.**
In our digital age, the tactile experience of sending a letter still holds a special charm, and that little click is a small part of it.

6 **An informal poll indicates a rise in the pleasure people get from 'successfully peeling a whole orange in one go'.**
It's a small, everyday challenge that brings a disproportionate amount of satisfaction when you achieve it. A mini-triumph for citrus lovers!

7 **Many are rediscovering the quiet satisfaction of 'watching a small, steady stream of water fill a glass'.**
There's something incredibly calming and almost mesmerising about it. A simple moment of peace in a busy day.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new piece of fruit in the shop will be ripe, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GIVING IT A GENTLE, ALMOST IMPERCEPTIBLE SQUEEZE!

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd ritual' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new pack of biscuits, especially if they're a fancy, artisan kind. What is it?**

ANSWER: CAREFULLY ARRANGING THEM INTO A PERFECT ROW OR STACK BEFORE TAKING THE FIRST ONE!

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those moments when a 'really strong, evocative scent' just instantly takes you back to a specific memory or feeling, don't we?**
  Whether it's the smell of freshly cut grass, a particular flower, or even an old book, what's a scent that instantly transports you, and where does it take you?

- **You know how sometimes you spot someone doing something really kind or thoughtful in public, and it just brightens your whole day?**
  Have you witnessed a small act of unexpected kindness recently that truly stuck with you? Tell us about the lovely things you've seen people doing.

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a parliament.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The collective noun for a group of snails is a 'trail'.

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06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Fire of London started in a bakery on Pudding Lane.
- It is illegal to sing 'Happy Birthday' in public for commercial purposes without paying royalties, as it was under copyright until 2016.
- The dot over the letters 'i' and 'j' is called a tittle.
- In Japan, it is considered rude to blow your nose in public.
- The world's largest hot dog was over 203 feet long.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in a lifetime.
- The fear of long words is called hippopotomonstrosesquippedaliophobia.
- The 'sixth' sick sheik's 'sixth' sheep's sick is considered one of the hardest tongue twisters in the English language.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES THU 5 NOV 2026

On this day

Day 309 of the year, 56 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: All Jesuit Saints and Blesseds; Christian feast day: Saint Domninus of Grenoble; Christian feast day: Blessed Bernhard Lichtenberg; Christian feast day: Berthild of Chelles. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1985 — Annet Mahendru, American actress
- 1969 — Pat Kilbane, American actor, comedian, director and screenwriter
- 1975 — Lisa Scott-Lee, Welsh singer-songwriter
- 1938 — Joe Dassin, American-French singer-songwriter (died 1980)
- 1947 — Peter Noone, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1941 — Art Garfunkel, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1976 — Sebastian Arcelus, American actor
- 1963 — Tatum O'Neal, American actress and author

THE DAY TODAY

- 2009 — U.S. Army Major Nidal Hasan murders 13 and wounds 32 at Fort Hood, Texas in the deadliest mass shooting at a U.S. military installation.
- 2013 — India launches the Mars Orbiter Mission, its first interplanetary probe.
- 1943 — World War II: Bombing of the Vatican.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2006 — Saddam Hussein, the former president of Iraq, and his co-defendants Barzan Ibrahim al-Tikriti and Awad Hamed al-Bandar, are sentenced to death in the al-Dujail trial for their roles in the 1982 massacre of 148 Shia Muslims.
- 2007 — China's first lunar satellite, Chang'e 1, goes into orbit around the Moon.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2015 — Rona Ambrose takes over after Stephen Harper as the Leader of the Conservative Party of Canada.
- 2007 — The Android mobile operating system is unveiled by Google.

- 1983 — The Byford Dolphin diving bell accident kills five and leaves one severely injured.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES FRI 6 NOV 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 310 of the year, 55 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Barlaam of Khutyn; Christian feast days: Blessed Christina von Stommeln; Christian feast days: Demetrian; Christian feast days: Illtud. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1926 — Frank Carson, Northern Irish comedian and actor (died 2012)
- 1949 — Elwood Edwards, American voice actor (died 2024)
- 1990 — Bowen Yang, Australian-born American actor, comedian, podcaster, and writer
- 1960 — Lance Kerwin, American actor (died 2023)
- 1986 — Conor Sammon, Irish footballer
- 1972 — Rebecca Romijn, American model and actress
- 1952 — Michael Cunningham, American novelist and screenwriter
- 1963 — Rozz Williams, American singer, musician and artist (died 1998)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2025 — Canadian ostrich cull: The Government of Canada kills 314 ostriches after H5N8 is detected in an ostrich farm in Edgewood, BC.
- 1869 — In New Brunswick, New Jersey, Rutgers College defeats Princeton University (then known as the College of New Jersey), 6–4, in the first official intercollegiate American football game.
- 1976 — Uttawar forced sterilisations: Mass vasectomy of nearly 800 men of Uttawar village, Palwal district, Haryana during India's Emergency imposed by Indira Gandhi.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1217 — The Charter of the Forest is sealed at St Paul's Cathedral, London by King Henry III, acting under the regency of William Marshall, 1st Earl of Pembroke which re-establishes for free men rights of access to the royal forest that had been eroded by William the Conqueror and his...
- 1860 — Abraham Lincoln is elected the 16th president of the United States with only 40% of the popular vote, defeating John C. Breckinridge, John Bell, and Stephen A. Douglas in a four-way race.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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